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SUKIKART

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
Programming Languages

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INTRODUCTION

Sari-sari stores are very common in Filipino communities. They serve as go-to places for people who need to buy food, snacks, and daily essentials in small amounts. Most sari-sari stores still operate in the traditional way — customers go to the store, ask for what they need, and pay in cash. However, with the rise of technology and the internet, many businesses today are starting to go online.

With this idea, our group decided to develop a simple e-commerce website named as SukiKart. The main goal of the system is to help the store owner sell products online and make it easier for customers to place their orders without needing to go to the store physically. The website allows customers to register or log in, view available products and add items to their cart. There is also a search bar, product categories and a simple checkout process.

This project aims to help sari-sari stores keep up with digital changes and show that even small businesses can benefit from having an online presence.

Background of the developed system

Many sari-sari stores still rely on manual processes, such as writing down orders or just remembering customer purchases. This can lead to problems like missing orders, running out of stock without warning, and customers having to wait in line or visit the store only to find out the item they need is unavailable. We noticed that not all small businesses have access to online platforms because most systems are made for bigger stores or more complex operations. That's why we created this e-commerce website inspired by a sari-sari store. It is designed to be simple, user-friendly, and suited to the needs of both the store owner and the customers.

Through this system, customers can log in to browse available products, use the cart feature to edit quantities or remove items, and proceed to checkout. Product categories such as snacks, drinks, canned goods, instant noodles, household items and school supplies are clearly organized for easier navigation. On the admin side, the store owner

can update product listings, manage customer accounts, and keep track of orders and payment status.

This system is meant to save time, reduce manual errors, and improve the overall buying and selling experience. Most importantly, it proves that even small, local stores can take advantage of digital tools to grow and serve their communities better.

Statement of the Problem

Sari-sari stores are important in Filipino communities because they provide everyday items in small amounts. However, most of these stores still use the traditional way of selling such as face-to-face and cash payments. In today's digital world, this can make it harder for them to grow and keep up with modern customer needs. Small businesses like sari-sari stores need help moving into the online space to stay competitive and offer better service. This project aims to solve that problem by creating a simple e-commerce website for a sari-sari store. The goal is to let customers order online and show how even small stores can benefit from using technology.

Objectives of the developed system

General Objective:

- To develop and create a basic e-commerce website for SukiKart that allows customers to order and buy products online.

Specific Objectives:

- To design a user-friendly website that allows customers to register, log in, and manage their profiles.
- To develop a product list where consumers can view an item category, and search for what they need.
- To implement a shopping cart and checkout process for seamless online purchases.
- To provide a convenient platform for the store owner to manage products.
- To show the potential benefits of e-commerce for small business stores like sari-sari store to grow and serve their customers better

Significance of the developed system

This system is significant as it highlights the potential of digital technology in transforming the operations of small-scale businesses, particularly sari-sari stores in Filipino communities.

For Sari-Sari Store Owners. The website can make daily tasks easier such as tracking orders, updating product lists, and managing customer information. This could help the store run more smoothly and avoid common problems, such as missing items or running

out of stock without warning.

For Customers. The website offers convenience, allowing customers to browse, select, and purchase products from the comfort of their homes. Instead of walking to the store and finding out something is unavailable, they can now check online, place their order, and just wait for it.

For the Community. This project encourages the adoption of digital solutions in local small-scale businesses, potentially inspiring other small businesses to consider going online. It contributes to local economic growth by modernizing small-scale retail practices and promoting tech literacy in the community.

This system is also meaningful because it encourages other small businesses to consider using simple technology to grow. It's a reminder that digital tools aren't just for big companies because anyone can make use of them to serve their community better.

Scope and Limitation of the system

Scope

Our project creates a simple e-commerce system named as SukiKart. It aims to help them sell products online, moving from manual processes to a digital platform.

- Customers can create accounts and log in, helping the store track buyers and past orders.
- The website allows product browsing through categories (like snacks, drinks) and a search bar for quick item finding.
- Customers can add products to a shopping cart, adjust quantities, and remove items before checkout.
- A simple checkout process makes buying quick and straightforward.
- The owner can update product listings, including adding, modifying, or marking items as out of stock.
- The system can track customer orders and payment statuses, acting as a digital record of sales.
- The website is designed to be user-friendly, simple for both the store owner and customers, regardless of their computer skills.

Limitations

Our website is simple and thus has specific limitations:

- The system only supports PayPal and cash on delivery (COD), with no built-in integration for credit/debit cards or other online payment platforms.
- It doesn't offer advanced inventory management like automated low-stock alerts or supplier tracking, focusing only on marking items as 'out of stock'.
- It lacks direct customer service features like chat or messaging; communication outside the ordering process is manual.

- There are no marketing tools like discount codes or loyalty programs.
- It doesn't provide comprehensive sales reports or detailed business analytics.

METHODOLOGY

I. System Requirements Gathering

The requirements for the SukiKart E-commerce System were identified through analysis of typical sari-sari store operations and reference to existing e-commerce platforms. The goal was to simplify basic store functions into a user-friendly digital platform. Key requirements included:

- **User and Admin Management:** Secure registration and login for both customers and administrators, with comprehensive control for admins over all user accounts.
- **Product Management:** Tools for admins to manage product listings (add, edit, delete, categorize, price, add images) and for users to browse, search, and filter products.
- **Order and Checkout:** Features for customers to add items to a cart, proceed to checkout with various payment options, and view their order history. Admins can track, manage, and update order and payment statuses.
- **Centralized Admin Dashboard:** A dedicated interface for administrators to manage all aspects of products, orders, and users, ensuring secure, role-based access.

II. System Design

The following tools and technologies were selected based on their accessibility and suitability for small-scale retail operations:

- Frontend: HTML, Tailwind CSS
- Backend: PHP (Laravel Framework)
- Database: MySQL
- Payment API: PayPal
- Version Control: Git
- Tools and Platforms: Visual Studio Code, Composer, Github

III. System Development

The e-commerce system was divided into core modules:

User Management

- Registration and login
- User roles (customer, admin)
- CRUD operations for users (Create, Read, Update, Delete)

Product Management

- Admin functions to add, update, and delete items
- Product listings with categories, prices
- Image upload feature

Order Management

- Adding items to cart and checkout
- Order placement by customers
- Viewing and updating order status by admin
- Payment status tracking (e.g., paid, pending)

Admin Dashboard

- Central panel for managing products, orders, and user accounts
- Viewing customer and order details
- Role-based access control to restrict admin-only features

Summary, Conclusions, and Recommendation

Summary

This study focused on the design and development of a web-based SukiKart E-commerce System to help small retail store owners digitize their selling process and reach a broader customer base. The system was designed with accessibility, simplicity, and essential retail features.

The project identified key requirements through the observation of typical sari-sari store operations and inspiration from existing e-commerce platforms. The developed system includes modules for user registration, product catalog management, shopping cart and checkout processes, and order and user account administration.

Technologies such as HTML, CSS, Laravel (PHP), and MySQL were used to build the application, with GitHub for version control and Visual Studio Code as the primary development environment. The platform also integrates PayPal for cashless transactions, supporting modern payment convenience.

Conclusions

The SukiKart E-commerce System successfully meets the primary goals of digitizing sari-sari store operations while remaining user-friendly and functional. Key features such as comprehensive user management, product management, order management, and admin account management were implemented to provide a complete and practical tool for store owners. The integration of payment features and order management makes the platform competitive with basic e-commerce platforms, but specifically designed to the unique needs of small-scale sari-sari stores.

Recommendations

Based on the development and outcome of the project, the following recommendations are suggested for future enhancement and deployment:

1. Mobile App Version – To increase accessibility, especially for users with limited access to computers, a mobile application version could be developed.
2. Inventory Alerts – Implement automated alerts when stock levels are low to assist store owners in maintaining supply.
3. Analytics Dashboard – Add a dashboard to show sales reports, top-selling products, and customer insights.
4. Multiple Payment Options – Integrate additional payment gateways such as GCash or Maya to accommodate local user preferences.
5. Delivery Tracking – Integrate a basic delivery tracking system or a courier service API for more complete e-commerce functionality.
6. Security Enhancements – Add further security features such as CAPTCHA on login and two-factor authentication for admin accounts.

The system has the potential to empower small business owners by offering a low-cost, efficient way to participate in the digital economy. Continued improvement and user feedback would further optimize its use and long-term sustainability.

SOURCE CODE

Github link: <https://github.com/Kristoffer0221/saristore>